



YOUR SMILE CONFIDENCE PROFILE

How to describe exactly what you want

The vocabulary cosmetic dentists actually use, how to give useful feedback on a proposed shape, and why the trial smile is the step that decides whether you get what you pictured.

The Perfectionist · A Smile Confidence guide · General information, not dental advice

You already know what you want. This is how to say it.

Being specific about your own smile is unexpectedly hard, because most people have never been given the words. You end up saying "a bit shorter, but natural" and hoping it lands. It sometimes does. Relying on it is the reason people end up technically well-treated and quietly disappointed.

There are about six variables in play, and knowing their names changes the conversation completely. **Shade** is colour. **Shape** is the outline of each tooth, square through to rounded. **Length** is how far the front teeth come down, which affects how much shows when you talk. **Proportion** is the relationship between neighbouring teeth. **Midline** is whether the centre line sits with your face. **Gum line** is how much gum shows and whether it runs evenly.

The word to be most careful with is "natural". It means opposite things to different people, and it is the most common source of a mismatch between what somebody asked for and what they received. If you use it, say what you mean by it, ideally with a photograph.

IMAGE TO PLACE

Close crop of a shade guide being held up, or a trial smile mock-up on the bench. Shows the vocabulary the page is teaching.

Six ways to be precise about it

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 Bring photographs of smiles you like

Two or three, and ideally on faces roughly like yours. This is not vanity, it is the most efficient brief there is, and every cosmetic dentist would rather have it.

2 Bring one you actively dislike

Knowing what you want to avoid narrows things faster than knowing what you want. Very white and very uniform is exactly right for some people and wrong for others.

3 Use the six words

Shade, shape, length, proportion, midline, gum line. Say which of them bother you. Even getting it half right transforms the conversation.

4 Insist on a trial smile

A mock-up you can see and live with before anything permanent happens. For your profile this is the whole game. It converts a description into something you can actually judge.

5 Give feedback on the trial in specifics

Not "something is off." Too long at the corners, too square, too bright, the left one sits forward. Specific feedback is actionable and vague feedback is not.

6 Look at it in the conditions that matter to you

In daylight, in a photograph, on video. Teeth read differently in a dental chair than they do on your phone, and your phone is where you will judge them later.

The trial smile is where the decisions belong. Changing the shape at that stage is a conversation. Changing it after permanent work is fitted is a much bigger, more expensive one. If you take one thing from this guide, take the habit of being fussy early rather than politely quiet.

Signs your detail is being heard

- Someone wrote down what you said rather than nodding
- You were offered a trial or mock-up without having to push for it
- Your photographs were looked at properly and discussed
- You were asked what you mean by natural rather than assumed
- Changing your mind at the trial stage was treated as normal

IMAGE TO PLACE

Dr. Mehta and a patient reviewing photographs together on a screen, mid-discussion.

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Precision work is mostly iteration, and iteration needs appointments. The visit where you come back and say the left one still is not right is a normal part of the process here rather than an imposition.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

IMAGE TO PLACE

Detail work at the bench, tools in shot, tight crop on hands.

Bring these to your consultation

Thirty minutes goes a lot further with a couple of specifics in hand. Turning up with none of them is fine too.

1 Your reference photographs

Smiles you like, and at least one you do not. On your phone is fine.

2 Your written list

The specific things that bother you, in the six words if you can. People forget half of it in the room.

3 A recent photograph of yourself

Full face, smiling, in daylight. It is what the design is built around, and it is how you will judge the result later.

Thirty minutes, free, plus a preview of your smile

Bring the list and the photographs. Dr. Mehta will go through each item and tell you honestly what is achievable, and you will see a rendered preview of a possible result before you commit to anything.

Book your free 30 minutes

4600 Crowchild Trail NW, Suite 505, Calgary · (587) 327-8651

Nothing is done to your teeth at this appointment, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about cosmetic dental treatment. It is not dental advice, it is not a treatment plan, and it is not a comment on any other practice. What is achievable for your teeth depends on an in-person examination, and results differ from person to person. Any images you are shown are an illustration of a possible outcome, not a promise of one. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.